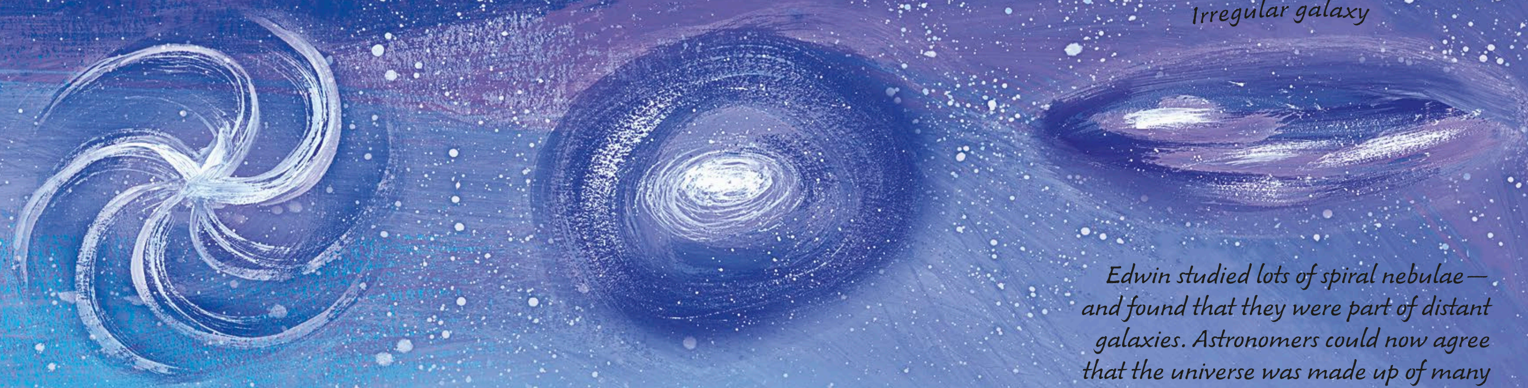


Edwin studied lots of spiral nebulae—and found that they were part of distant galaxies. Astronomers could now agree that the universe was made up of many galaxies of different shapes and sizes.

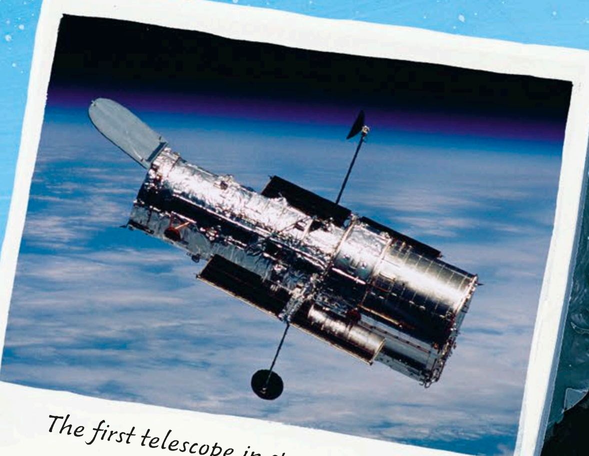
Galaxies far, far away

The telescope at the Mount Wilson Observatory gave Edwin a much better view of the mysterious nebulae. He was particularly interested in nebulae shaped liked spirals. At that time, the only galaxy astronomers knew about was our own—the Milky Way. Were nebulae clusters of stars within the Milky Way? Or could they be distant galaxies themselves?

Peering at a spiral nebula known as Andromeda, Edwin noticed that some stars changed in brightness. He figured out that less-bright stars were farther away, and he used this knowledge to calculate the distance of different stars from the Earth. The distance turned out to be enormous—at least three times farther than the outer limits of the Milky Way! This proved that Andromeda was a galaxy itself.

Edwin taught us how to unlock the secrets of space beyond our own galaxy.

Edwin discovered how changes in the color of light from distant stars and galaxies can tell us how far they are from the Earth.



The first telescope in space was named "Hubble" after Edwin.